Inventory Movement Review, FY2026

Oct 25, 2026 · @Genesis

At a glance

A large part of our product list is not working for us: 39% of stocked products were not used at all this year, while 14% of products do 80% of the work. Most "unusual" numbers come from our own stock moves and corrections, not from customers, and the system holds far more products, sites and warehouses than we actually use.

Question	Answer	What to do
Which products barely move, are falling or are unpredictable?	2,099 products were not used at all and 845 only rarely; 159 active products are falling; 353 are unpredictable. Only 34% are healthy.	Switch off unused products, stop reordering rarely used ones, review the falling ones with sales
When a number looks unusual, what caused it?	744 months were truly unusual for their product; 64% were caused by internal stock moves and corrections, only 5% by customers	Fix stocktake and transfer practices at the 6 sites with the most cases
Do a few products do most of the work?	Yes: 457 products (14%) make up 80% of all activity; finished products are 26% of the range but 65% of activity	Give the top 457 the closest attention; add backup supply at 6 sites that rely on 10 or fewer products
What else in the data needs fixing?	Only 27% of warehouses and 61% of stocked products were used; 1,109 products have no unit conversion	Archive unused records; add missing conversions and sales categories

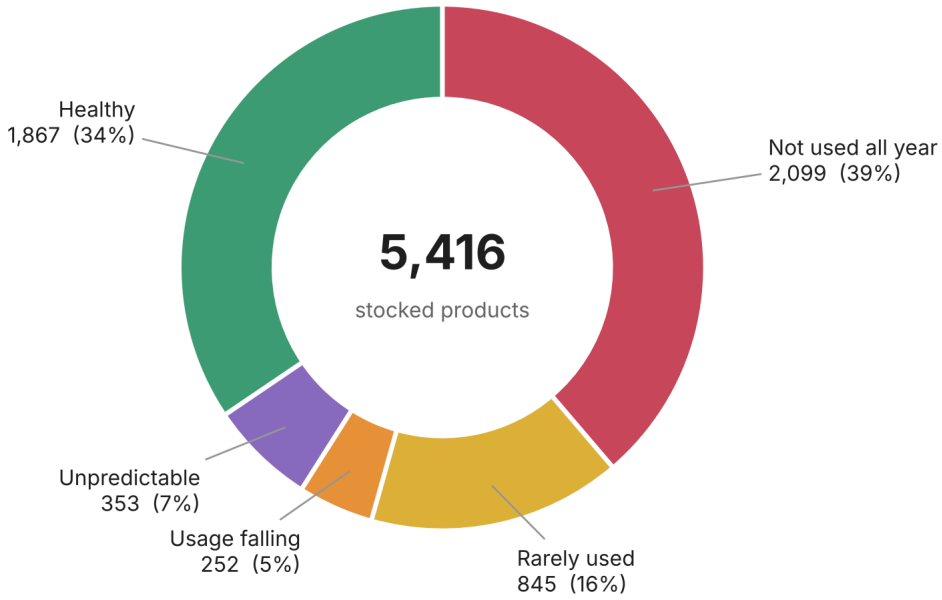
The year covered is July 2025 to June 2026 (the financial year), across 37 active sites in Australia and New Zealand.

Q1. Which products barely move, are falling or are unpredictable?

Only a third of our 5,416 stocked products are healthy. The biggest group, 2,099 products, was not used at all this year, and 1,384 of those are still marked active in the system.

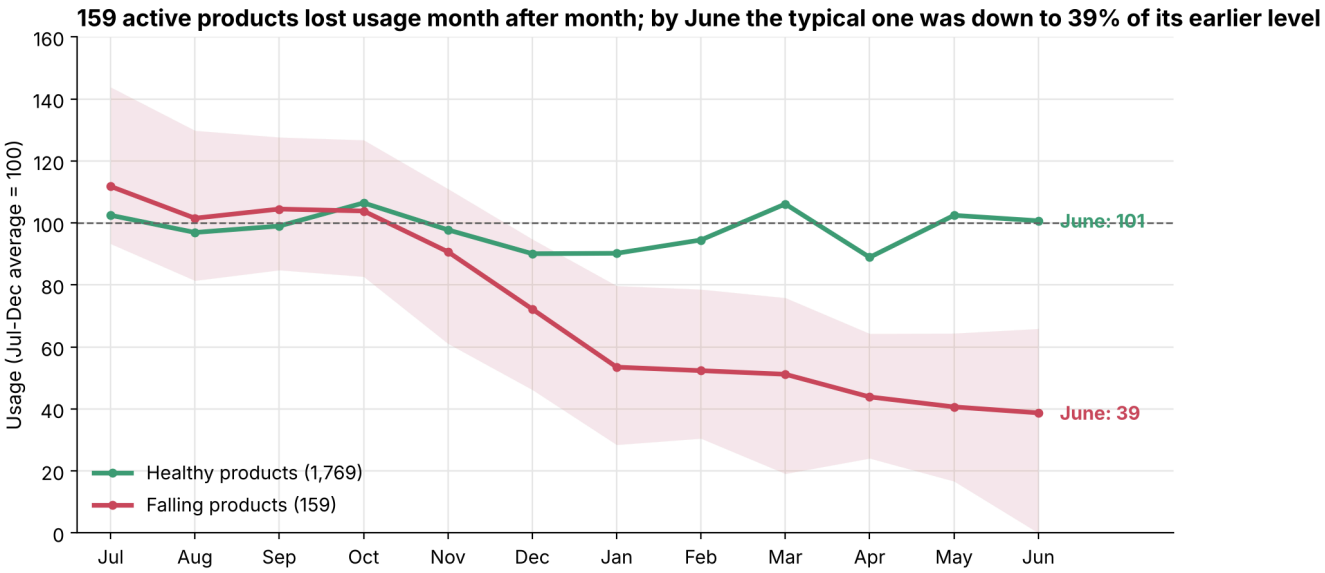
Each product sits in one group, based on its monthly usage (customer orders plus production use):

39% of stocked products were not used at all this year (1,384 still marked active); only 34% are healthy

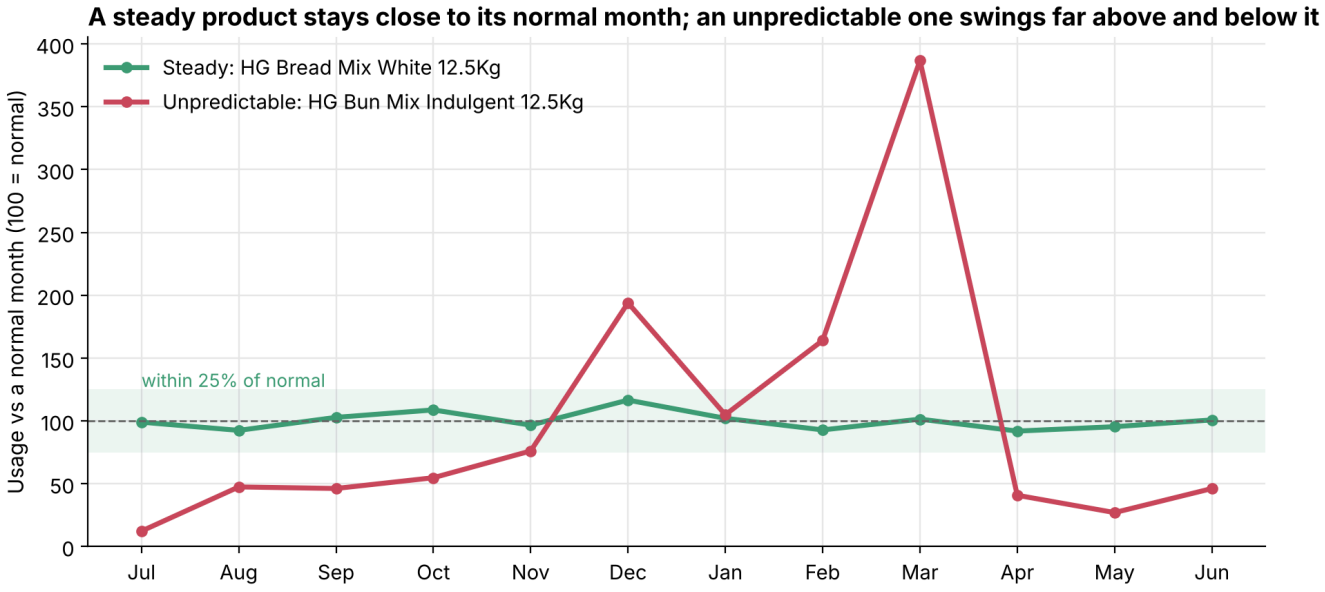


Rarely used (845). Used in three months or fewer, or not at all since April. 295 products have sat unused for longer than their shelf life, so some stock may need writing off.

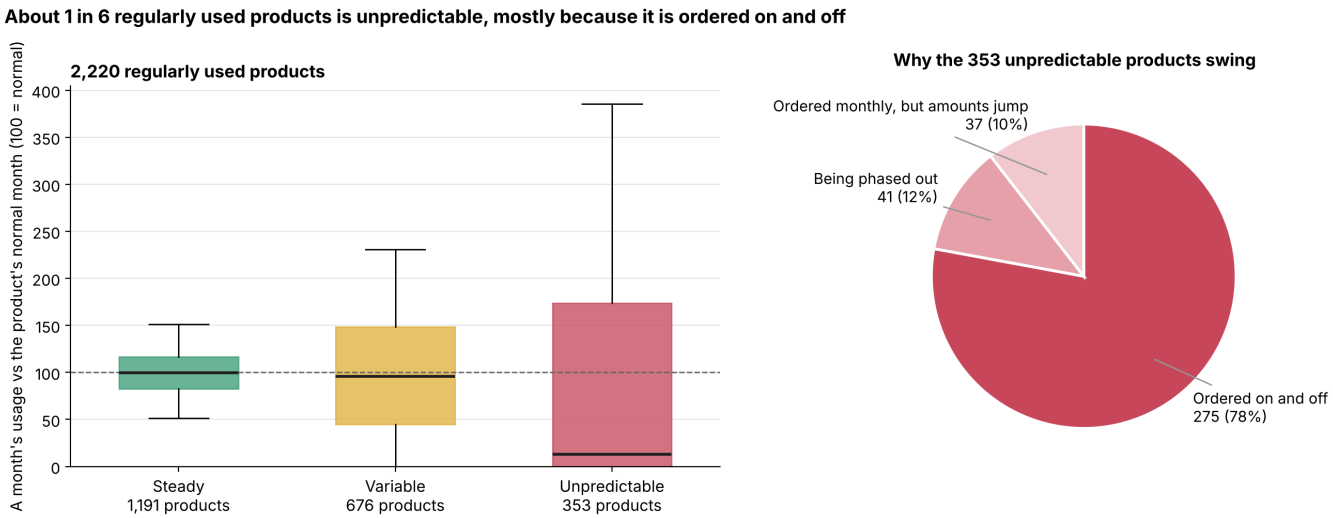
Falling (159 active). Used regularly, but usage dropped month after month: by June the typical one was down to 39% of its July to December level, while healthy products held steady.



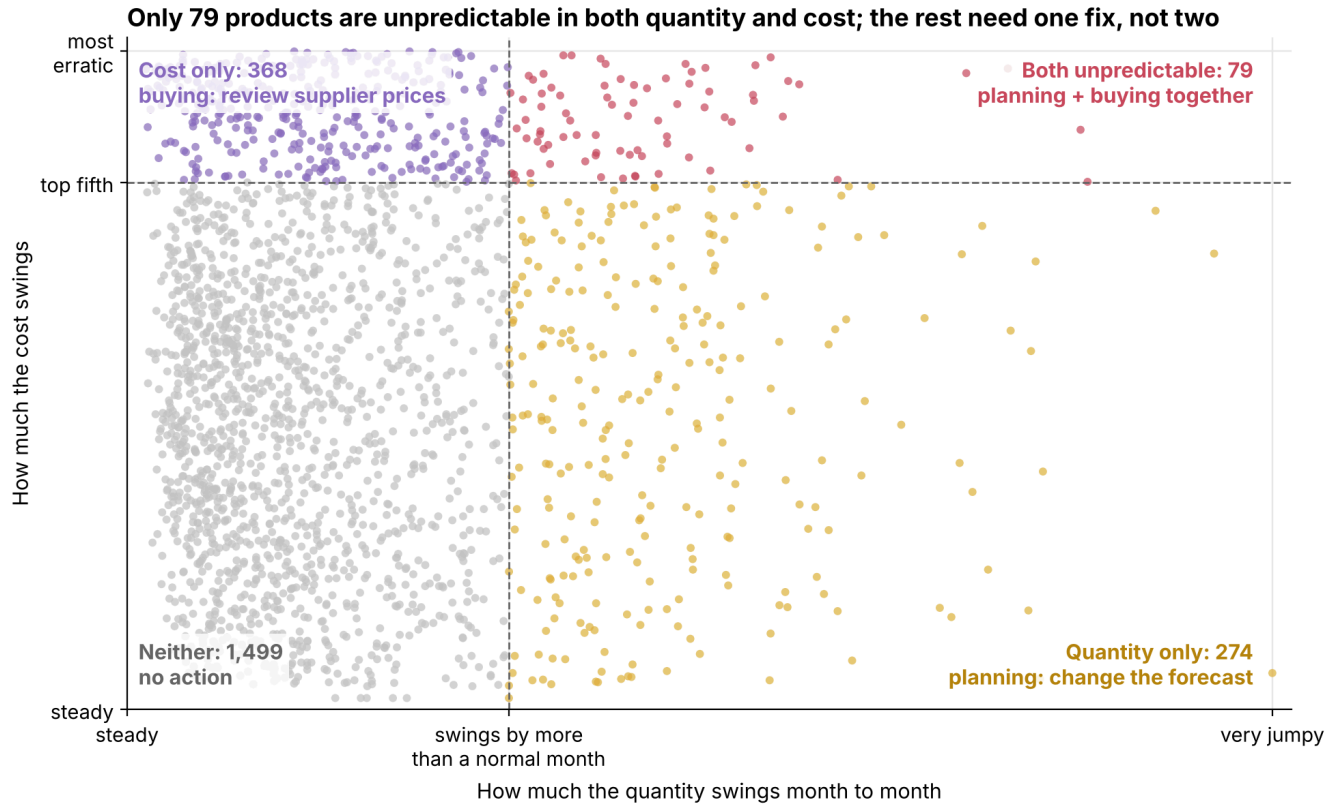
Unpredictable (353). Used regularly, but monthly usage swings far above and below its normal month, which makes them hard to plan.



The box plot shows how far a typical month strays from normal. A steady product's months stay between 83% and 117% of normal. An unpredictable product's typical month is only 13% of normal, with occasional spikes well above it: it sits idle most of the time, then a big order arrives. Most of them (275) are simply ordered on and off.



Unpredictable quantity and unpredictable cost are different problems that mostly hit different products. In the scatter plot each dot is a regularly used product: only 79 are unpredictable on both counts, 274 on quantity only and 368 on cost only.



What to do:

- **Not used (2,099):** after a quick check, switch the 1,384 active ones off so they drop out of planning and reports.

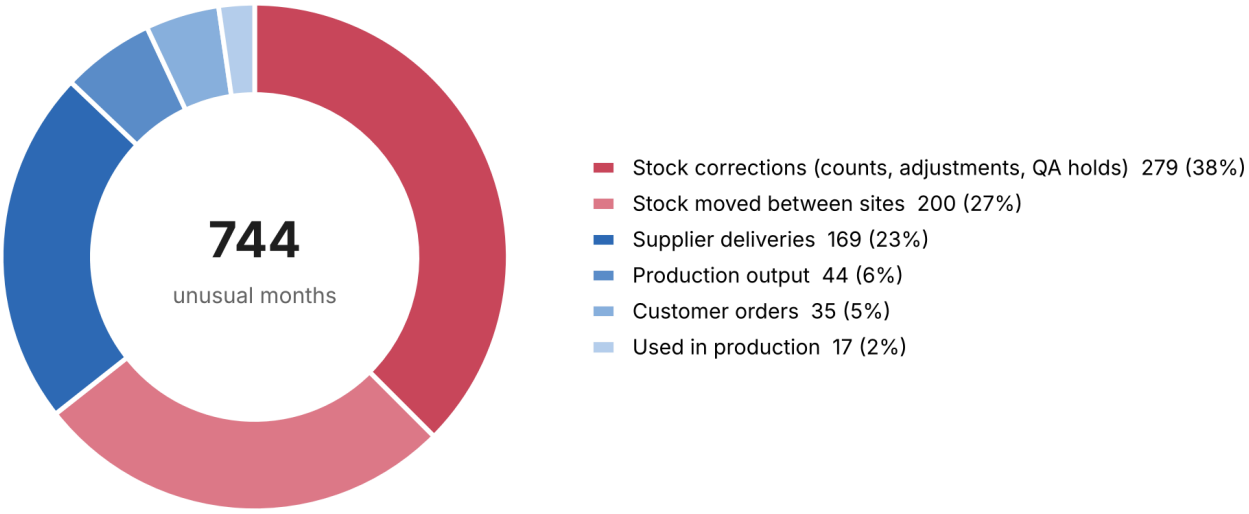
- **Rarely used (845):** stop automatic reordering; sell down or make to order. Review the 295 past their shelf life for write-off.
- **Falling (159):** sales and planning confirm whether each is being replaced or losing customers, and update its status.
- **Unpredictable (353):** planning changes how on-and-off products are forecast; buying reviews supplier prices for the cost-only products; both teams review the 79 together.

Q2. When a number looks unusual, what caused it?

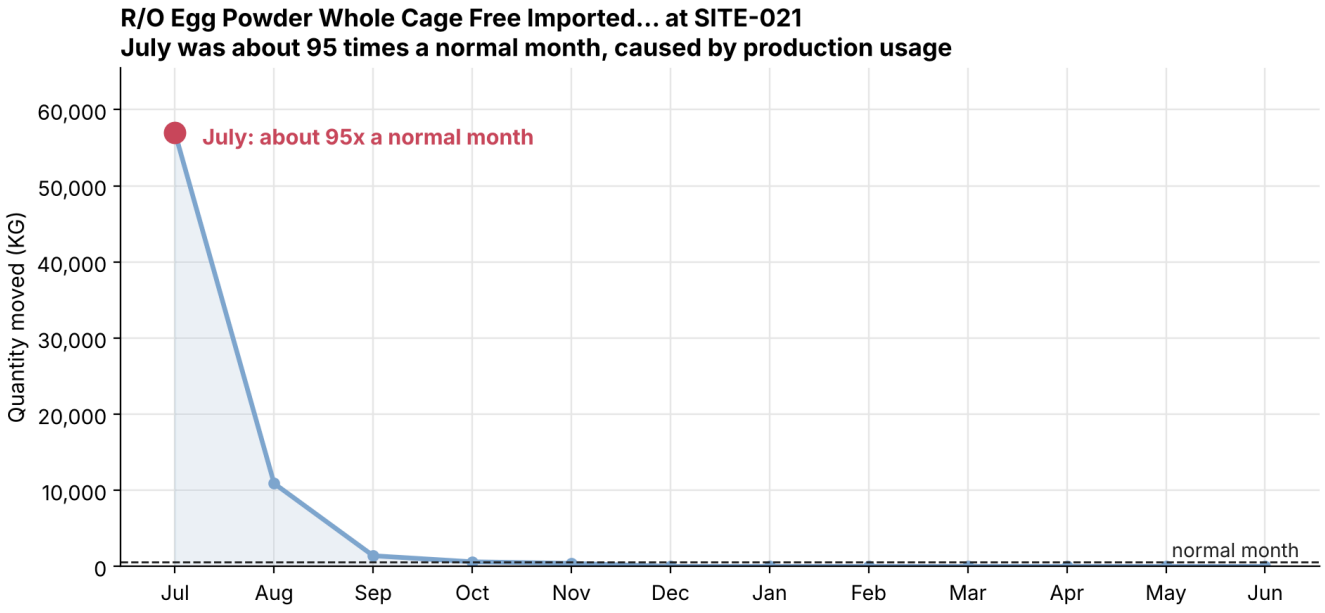
Out of 83,167 monthly records, 744 were truly unusual, and nearly two-thirds of those came from our own stock moves and corrections rather than from customers.

A big number is not automatically unusual: bulk flour and grain move in big numbers every month. So each product's month at each site was compared with that same product's normal month at that site. 825 records looked big but were normal for the product and need no action.

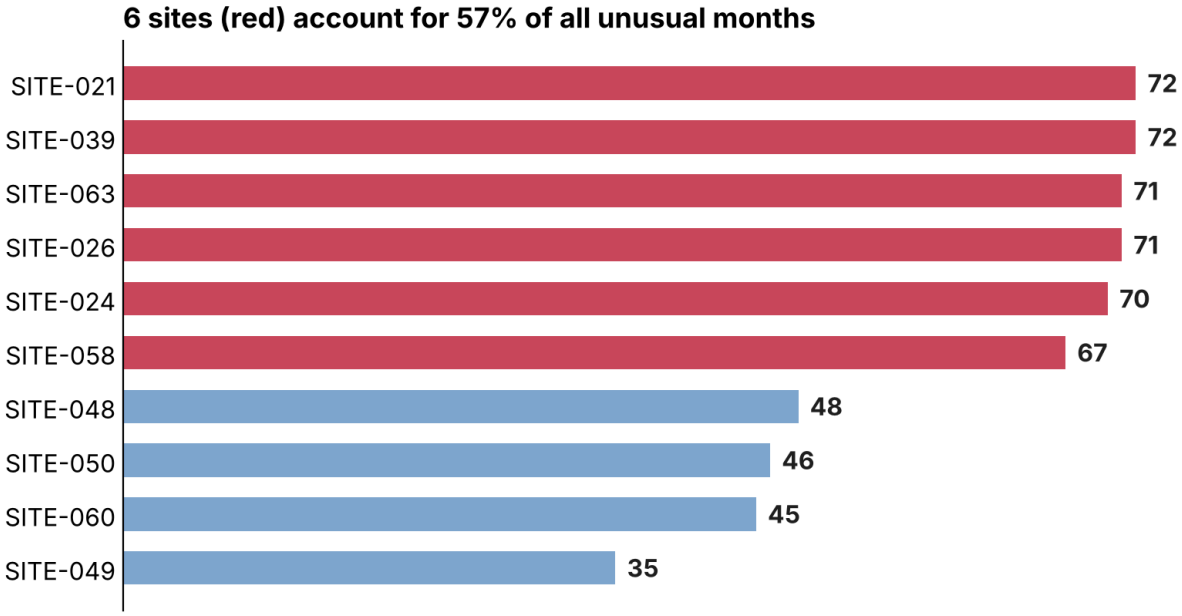
64% of the 744 unusual months come from internal stock moves and corrections (red), not from customers



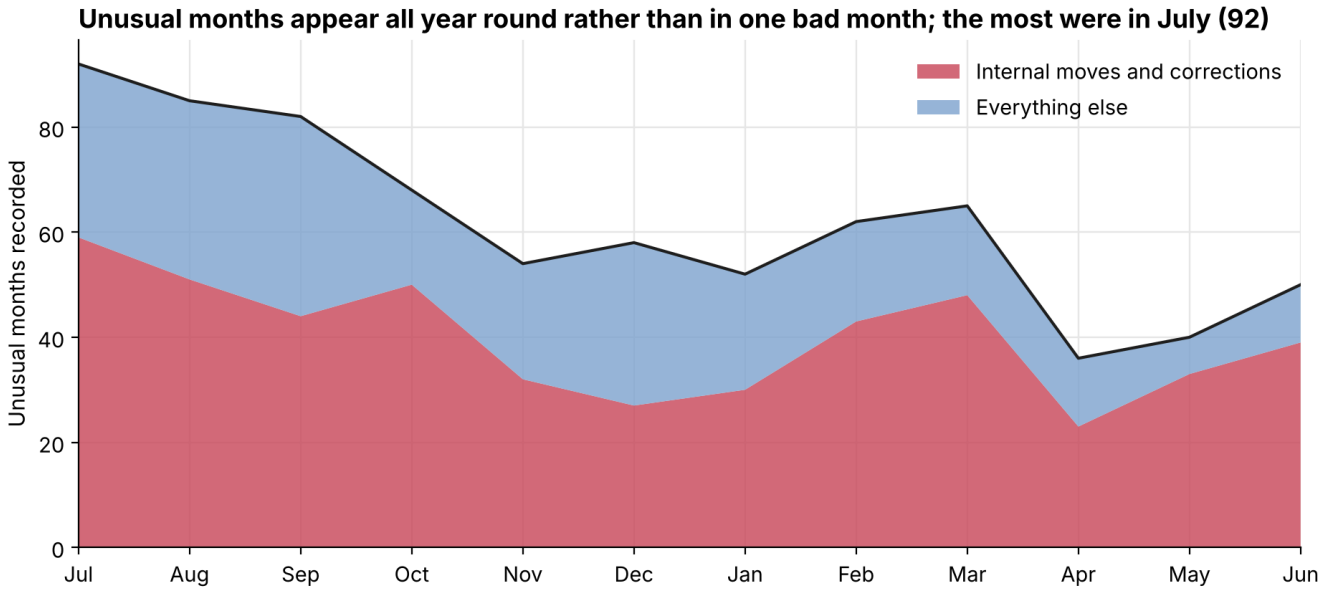
What an unusual month looks like, using the strongest example:



Unusual months cluster at a few sites. No single month hit every site at once, so there was no company-wide event (such as a year-end stocktake) distorting the year.



They also happen all year round rather than in one bad month: July had the most (92) and April the fewest (36), and internal causes lead in 11 of the 12 months (December is the exception).

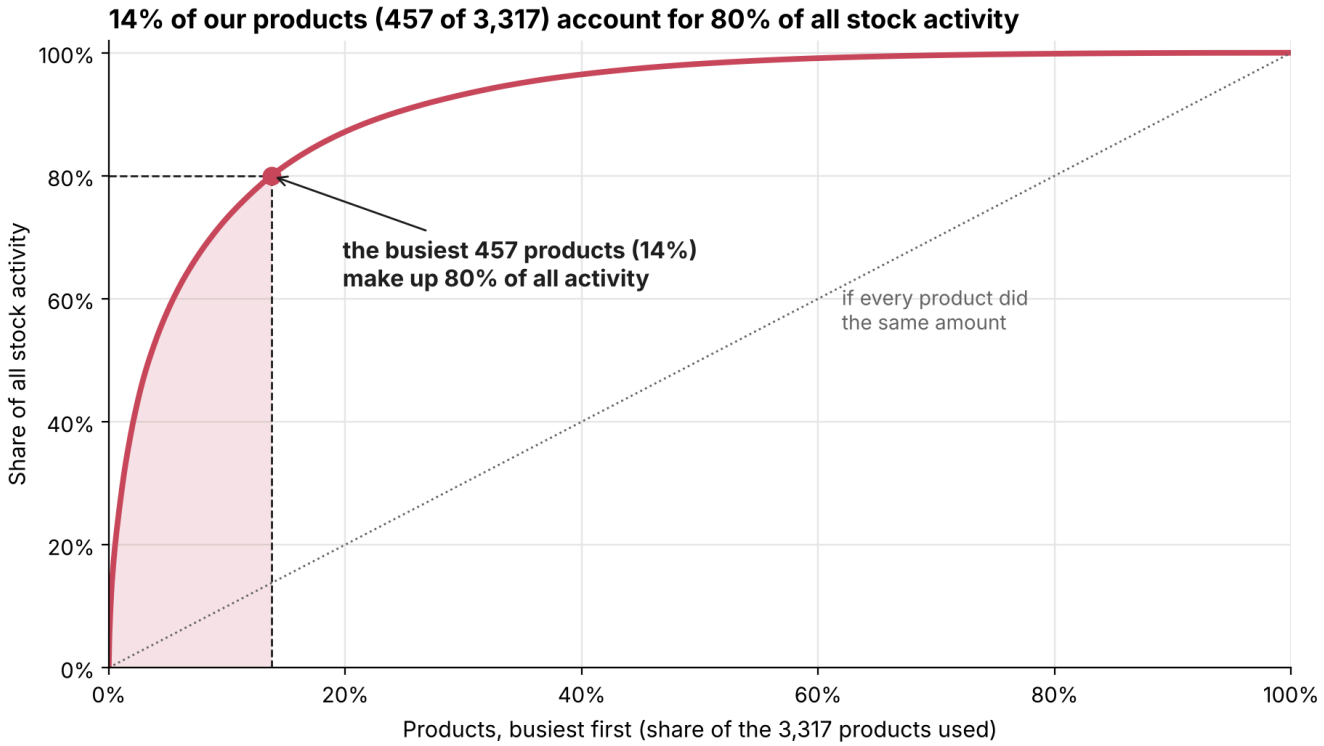


What to do:

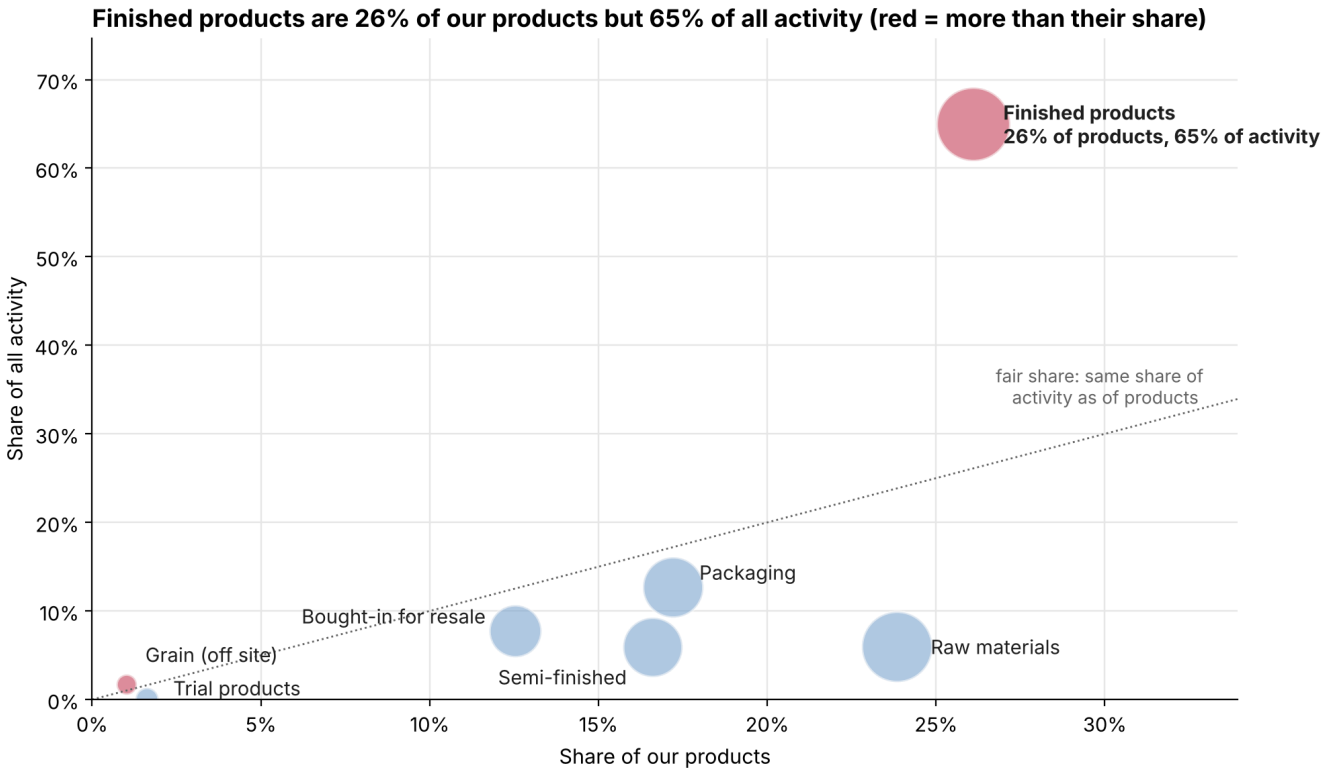
- **Treat most spikes as process issues, not demand.** Stock corrections and transfers (64% of cases) go to site operations to explain, not to planning to forecast.
- **Start with the 6 sites** (SITE-021, SITE-039, SITE-026, SITE-063, SITE-024, SITE-058): review how stocktakes and transfers are recorded there.
- **Check every month.** Run this comparison monthly so unusual records are caught and explained when they happen, not at year end.

Q3. Do a few products do most of the work?

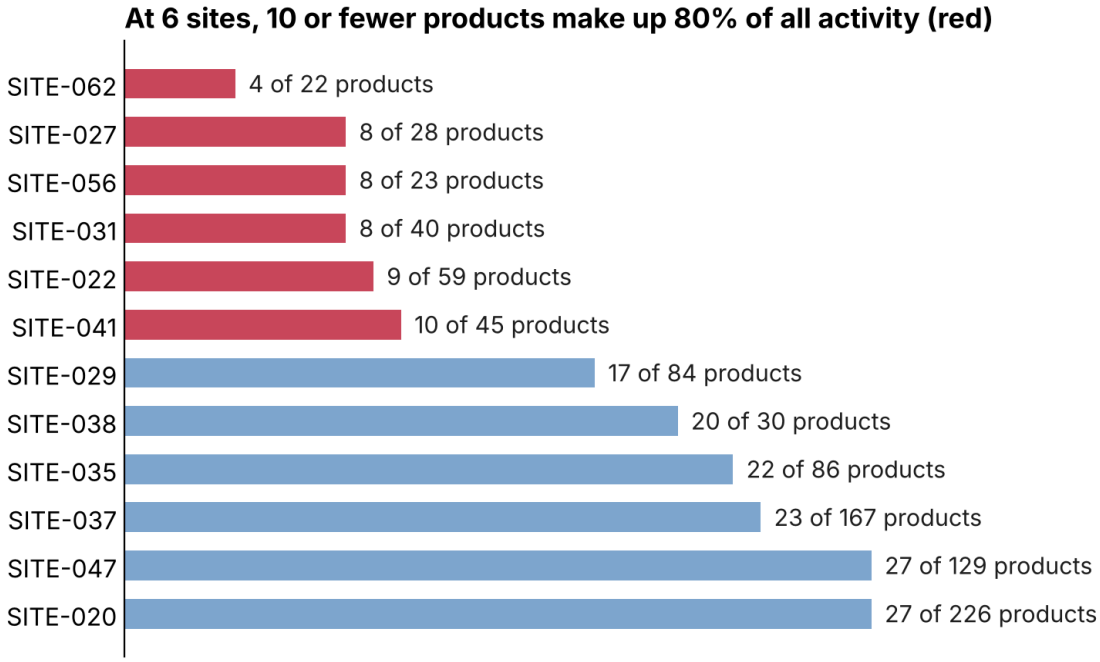
Yes. 457 products, 14% of those used this year, account for 80% of all stock activity. Activity here means the number of stock transactions, which lets products in kilos, cartons and units be compared fairly.



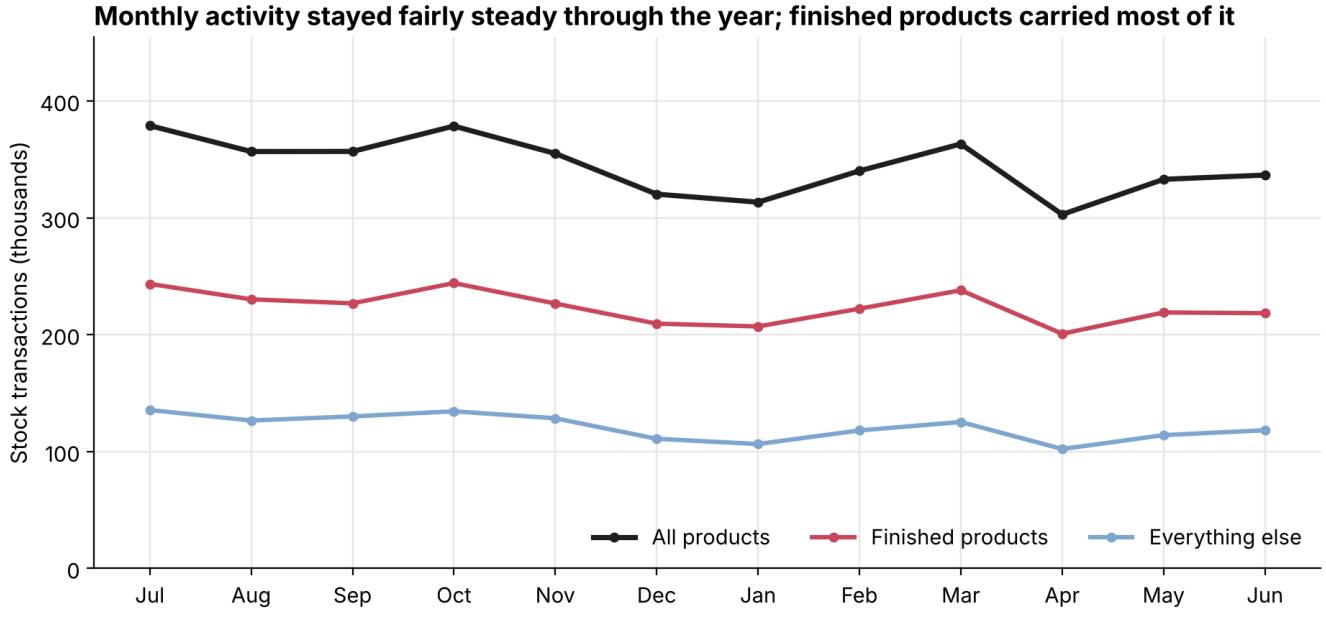
Finished products carry far more than their share: they are about a quarter of the range but two-thirds of the activity. Raw materials are the reverse, a quarter of the range but only 6% of activity.



Some sites depend on very few products. At 6 sites, 10 or fewer products make up 80% of everything the site does, so a shortage of one of them would be felt immediately.



Activity is steady through the year: the busiest month was only 1.25 times the quietest, and finished products carried about 65% of it every month. The busiest products are stable too: each month about 70% of the top 20 are the same as the month before.



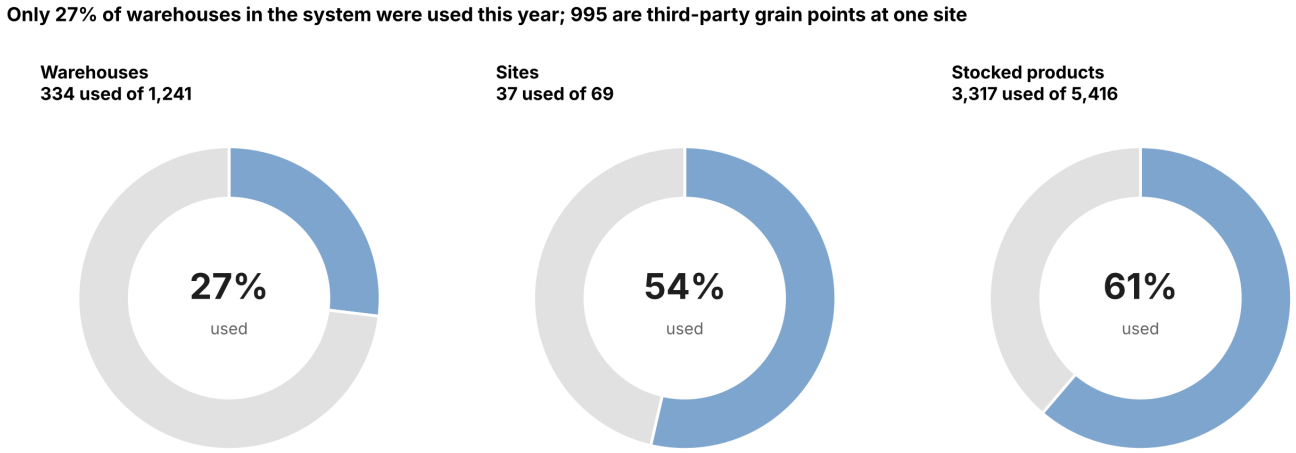
What to do:

- **Look after the top 457 first:** automatic reordering, frequent stock checks and a named owner for each.

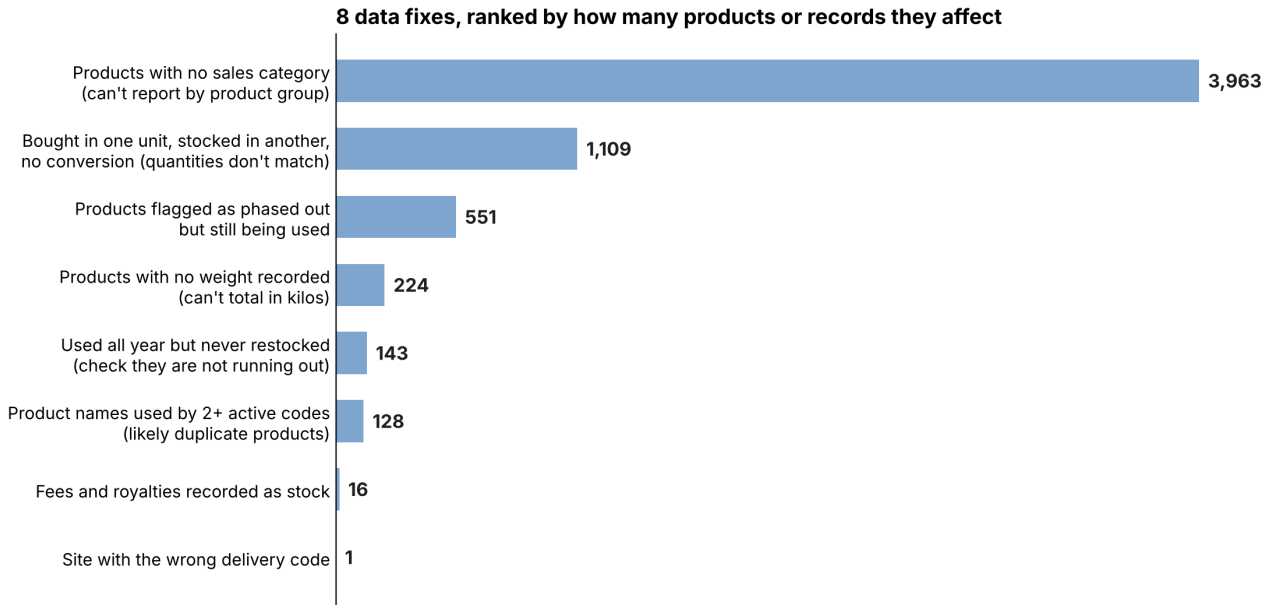
- **Protect the 6 dependent sites** (SITE-062, SITE-027, SITE-056, SITE-031, SITE-022, SITE-041): make sure each key product there has a second supplier or a backup site.
- **Plan the busiest products with a steady routine,** since the top group changes little from month to month.

Q4. What else in the data needs fixing?

The system is cluttered: only 334 of 1,241 warehouses (27%) and 37 of 69 sites were used this year. 995 of the warehouses are third-party grain receival points recorded at a single site.



A handful of data fixes would make reporting much more reliable. Each bar shows what the problem means for the business and how many products or records it affects.



Fix	Why it matters	Who
Archive unused warehouses, sites and products	Planning runs and reports show only what is real	System owner
Add unit conversions for 1,109 products bought in one unit and stocked in another	Purchase and stock quantities can be compared	Master data team
Complete sales categories (3,963 products blank)	Reporting by product group becomes possible	Sales operations
Correct the status of 551 "phased out" products still in use, and merge true duplicates among 128 shared names	Status and product lists can be trusted	Master data team
Record weights for 224 products	Stock can be totalled in kilos	Master data team
Check 143 products used all year but never restocked	They may be about to run out	Planning
Remove 16 fees and royalties from stock, and fix SITE-038's delivery code (it points to SITE-039)	Small errors that distort stock and delivery records	System owner

How the numbers were produced

Every number and chart here comes from the notebook inventory_movement_analysis.ipynb, run on the six system extracts for July 2025 to June 2026. Re-running it on a new year's extracts refreshes all of them.

Term	What it means here
Usage	What customers ordered plus what production used, per product per month
Rarely used	Used in 3 months or fewer, or not used at all from April to June

Term	What it means here
Falling	Used regularly, and usage dropped steadily, ending the year well below where it started
Unpredictable	Used regularly, but monthly usage swings by more than its own normal month
Unusual month	A month far outside that product's normal range at that site
Activity	The number of stock transactions; used to compare products whatever their unit

To run it: put the six CSV files in a folder called data next to the notebook, then choose Restart & Run All in Jupyter (about 20 seconds). Charts are saved to outputs/figures and all supporting lists, such as the 2,099 unused products, to outputs/analysis_tables.xlsx.